their nose to spite their own face. Therefore, one day before the expiry of the 23 April 'drop-dead' deadline, the Chinese finally agreed to the listing of Masood Azhar as a proscribed individual on the 1267 Sanctions Committee. The date agreed upon for the listing was 1 May 2019. The Chinese still succeeded in amending the text of the decision in order that references to the Government of Pakistan were removed from the citation. There was also no reference to the Pulwama terrorist attack. The Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson justified the volte-face by claiming that the sponsors of the proposal had submitted 'revised materials' for the Sanctions Committee to consider and that, after taking these revised materials and the opinions of relevant parties into consideration, China had no objection to the proposal. This was a way of giving 'face' to the Chinese.

The listing of Masood Azhar was a significant achievement. In public, India welcomed the decision, calling it a 'step in the right direction to demonstrate the international community's resolve to fight against terrorism and its enablers'. There was no reference to China; it was not necessary because the world knew of China's decade-long efforts to block this listing. Towards the end of the process, China was dissatisfied by Pakistan's insistence that it block the listing because China realized that it had no further advantage to gain in prolonging the matter. However, to mollify Pakistan, President Xi Jinping met Pakistan Prime Minister Imran Khan in China at the Second Belt and Road Summit on 29 April 2019. He reiterated support for the China–Pakistan Economic Corridor as a way of showing China's commitment to Pakistan, and appealed for de-escalation of tension between India and Pakistan to underscore China's role in South Asia security. All this made little difference in the end, as it turned out, on the results of the general election in India. The Chinese tactic of kicking the can down the road would not